

Brad's backstory leading up to *ChooseFI* is a perfect example. When he began teaching others how to redeem credit card reward points for free travel, he didn't have a good model on which to scale his business. So he would schedule two thirty-minute calls and explain the process to people over his lunch hour while he worked as an accountant full-time. He didn't charge for his time. It was an inefficient way to build a business and a horrible way to grow his income quickly, but he was building trust and growing a network of personal relationships. He said, "my entire success with my three different websites, and certainly, my two most recent ones, *Travel Miles 101* and *ChooseFI*, comes down to those relationships."

You shouldn't help people with the expectation that they owe you something in return. But when you help people, more often than not they will want to help you, too. It's just the way the world works.

Jonathan

Only in the last two years have I begun to appreciate the power of "networking." Historically, I always attached a negative connotation to that word—it felt spammy or insincere.

In reality, "networking" means going through life with a generous spirit, meeting people with similar mindsets, and